5 Paragraph 6.1 is deleted and the subsequent paragraphs are renumbered accordingly.

Part G

Special requirements

Regulation 20

Protection of vehicle, special category and ro-ro spaces

6 The title of regulation 20 is replaced by the following:

"Regulation 20 Protection of vehicle, special category, open and closed ro-ro spaces, and weather decks intended for the carriage of vehicles"

1 Purpose

7 Paragraph 1.1 is replaced by the following:

".1 fire protection systems shall be provided to adequately protect the ship from the fire hazards associated with vehicle, special category and ro -ro spaces, and weather deck intended for the carriage of vehicles;"

2 General requirements

2.1 Application

SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.550(108).pdf

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION FOR THE SAFETY OF LIFE AT SEA, 1974
- 4 -
2 General requirements
2.1 Application

8 The following new paragraph 2.1.3 is added after existing paragraph 2.1.2:

"2.1.3 Passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026, including those constructed before 1 July 2012, shall also comply with regulations 20.4.1.6, 20.4.4 and 20.6.2.3, as adopted by resolution MSC.550(108)."

3 Precaution against ignition of flammable vapours in closed vehicle spaces, closed ro-ro spaces and special category spaces

9 Paragraph 3.1.5 is replaced by the following:

"3.1.5 Permanent openings

In cargo ships, permanent openings in the side plating, the ends or deckhead of the space shall be so situated that a fire in the cargo space does not endanger stowage areas and embarkation stations for survival craft and accommodation spaces, service spaces and control stations in superstructures and deckhouses above the cargo spaces."

4 Detection and alarm

SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.550(108).pdf
spaces and control stations in superstructures and deckhouses above the cargo spaces."
4 Detection and alarm

10 The following new paragraph is added under the existing title of section 4 (Detection and alarm):

"Passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026 , including those constructed

before 1 July 2012, shall comply with the requirements of paragraph 4.1.6 not later than the first survey on or after 1 January 2028."

4.1 Fixed fire detection and fire alarm systems

11 Section 4.1 (Fixed fire detection and fire alarm systems) is replaced by the following:

"4.1 Fixed fire detection and fire alarm systems

The requirements of paragraphs 4.1.1 through 4.1.4 shall only apply to passenger ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026. Passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026, including those constructed before 1 July 2012, shall comply with the requirements of paragraph 4.1.6 and the previously applicable requirements

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with the requirements of paragraph 4.1.6 and the previously applicable requirements

of paragraph 4.1. The requirements of paragraph 4.1.5 shall apply to cargo ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026. Cargo ships constructed before 1 January 2026 shall comply with the previously applicable requirements of paragraph 4.1.

4.1.1 In vehicle, special category and ro -ro spaces, there shall be provided an individually identifiable fixed fire detection and fire alarm system. The system shall comply with the requirements of the Fire Safety Systems Code.

4.1.1.1 The fixed fire detection and fire alarm system shall provide smoke and heat detection throughout vehicle, special category and ro -ro spaces. The Administration may accept linear heat detectors as the required system for heat detection.

The system shall be capable of rapidly detecting the onset of fire. The location of

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SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf
URL:
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RESOLUTION MSC.550(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024)
AMENDMENTS TO CHAPTERS II-2 AND V OF THE
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detectors shall be to the satisfaction of the Administration, taking into account the effects of ventilation and other relevant factors. After being installed, the system shall be tested under normal ventilation conditions and shall give an overall response time to the satisfaction of the Administration.

4.1.2 If a fixed water -based deluge system is used for vehicle, special category and ro-ro spaces, then a fire detection and fire alarm system identifiable to the same sections of the deluge system shall be arranged.

4.1.3 The fire detection and fire alarm system shall be designed with a system interface which provides logical and unambiguous presentation of the information, to allow a quick and correct understanding and decision -making. In particular, section

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SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf
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allow a quick and correct understanding and decision -making. In particular, section

numbering of the alarm system shall coincide with that of other systems, such as a

fixed water-based fire-extinguishing system or video monitoring system, if available.
4.1.4 There shall be provided a fixed fire detection and fire alarm system for the area on the weather deck intended for the carriage of vehicles. The fixed fire detection system shall be capable of rapidly detecting the onset of the fire anywhere on the area. The type of detectors and their spacing and location shall be to the satisfaction of the Administration, taking into account the effects of weather conditions, cargo obstruction and other relevant factors. Different settings may be used for specific operation sequences, such as during loading or unloading and during voyage, in order to reduce the false alarms.
4.1.5 In cargo ships, vehicle spaces, special category spaces and ro -ro spaces
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SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.550(108).pdf
to reduce the false alarms.
4.1.5 In cargo ships, vehicle spaces, special category spaces and ro -ro spaces
shall be provided with a fixed fire detection and fire alarm system complying with the requirements of the Fire Safety Systems Code. The fixed fire detection system shall be capable of rapidly detecting the onset of fire. The type of detectors and their spacing and location shall be to the satisfaction of the Administration, taking into account the effects of ventilation and other relevant factors. After being installed, the system shall be tested under normal ventilation conditions and shall give an overall response time to the satisfaction of the Administration.
4.1.6 For passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026 , including those constructed before 1 July 2012, a fixed fire detection and fire alarm system complying with the requirements of the Fire Safety Systems Code shall be provided in special
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SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf
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https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.550(108).pdf
with the requirements of the Fire Safety Systems Code shall be provided in special
category spaces, open and closed ro-ro and vehicle spaces. The fixed fire detection system shall be capable of rapidly detecting the onset of fire. The fixed fire detection and fire alarm system shall provide smoke and heat detection throughout vehicle, special category and ro-ro spaces. In this context, heat detectors shall comply with the spacing and coverage area requirements as applicable for smoke detectors. Heat detectors are only required where there is already a smoke detector."
4.3 Special category spaces
12 Paragraph 4.3.1 is replaced by the following:
"4.3.1 An efficient fire patrol system shall be maintained in special category spaces."
RESOLUTION MSC.550(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024)
AMENDMENTS TO CHAPTERS II-2 AND V OF THE
INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION FOR THE SAFETY OF LIFE AT SEA, 1974
- 6 -
13 The following n ew section 4.4 is added after existing section 4.3 (Special category
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SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.550(108).pdf

13 The following n ew section 4.4 is added after existing section 4.3 (Special category spaces):

"4.4 Video monitoring

The requirements of paragraphs 4.4.1 and 4.4.2 apply to ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026. Passenger ships with vehicle, special category or ro-ro spaces constructed before 1 January 2026, including those constructed before 1 July 2012, shall comply with the requirements of paragraphs 4.4.1 and 4.4.2 not later than the first survey on or after 1 January 2028.

4.4.1 For passenger ships, an effective video monitoring system shall be arranged in vehicle, special category and ro -ro spaces for continuous monitoring of these spaces. The system shall be provided with immediate playback capability to allow for quick identification of fire location, as far as practicable. Cameras shall be installed to cover the whole space, high enough to see over cargo and vehicles after loading.

SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf

URL:

https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.550(108).pdf

cover the whole space, high enough to see over cargo and vehicles after loading.

4.4.2 The videos recorded by this monitoring system shall be available for replay at a continuously manned control station or at the safety centre for at least seven days for installation on ro -ro passenger ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026 and 24 hours for existing ro-ro passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026, including those constructed before 1 July 2012 . The correspondence between any one video camera and the section of the fixed water-based fire-extinguishing system protecting the space covered by this camera shall be clearly displayed close to the video monitor. Continuous monitoring of the video image by the crew is not required."

5 Structural fire protection

14 Section 5 (Structural fire protection) is replaced by the following:

"5 Structural fire protection and arrangement of openings

SOURCE: MSC.550(108).pdf

URL:

https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.550(108).pdf

14 Section 5 (Structural fire protection) is replaced by the following:

"5 Structural fire protection and arrangement of openings

This paragraph applies to passenger ships constructed on or after 1 January 2026. Passenger ships constructed before 1 January 2026 shall comply with the previously applicable requirements of paragraph 5.

5.1 Structural fire protection

5.1.1 In passenger ships carrying more than 36 passengers, the boundary bulkheads and decks of special category and ro-ro spaces shall be insulated to "A-60"